

TSS Interview Questions ($t=84\text{ m}$)
(**Answer:** $t=XX\text{ m}$ ($xx:xx:xx - xx:xx:xx$))
(Pxx) - FirstName LastName
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Interview date: xxxx-xx-xxTxx:xx:xxZ

1 Introduction ($t=10\text{ m}$) (**Answer:** $t=xx\text{ m}$) ($xx:xx:xx - xx:xx:xx$)

The purpose of this interview is to understand the practices and experiences of scam-baiters. By understanding their motivations, strategies, and challenges, we aim to gather valuable insights that can inform efforts to combat scams.

1. Can you tell me about your role as a scam-baiter and what motivated you to start scam-baiting?
($t=3\text{ m}$)

Answer:

2. How long have you been engaging in scam-baiting activities, and what experience do you have in this field? ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

3. How often do you engage in scam-baiting? ($t=1\text{ m}$)

Answer:

4. Do you focus on a particular type of scam? If so, what types do you target and why? ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

5. What is your technical background? Do you have any experience with programming or cybersecurity? ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

2 Planning and Preparation ($t=15\text{ m}$) (**Answer:** $t=xx\text{ m}$) ($xx:xx:xx - xx:xx:xx$)

In this section, we explore the preparatory steps that scam-baiters undertake before engaging with scammers. By understanding these steps, we can develop strategies for creating more effective scam-baiting dialogues.

1. How do you plan and prepare before engaging with scammers? ($t=3\text{ m}$)

Answer:

2. What factors influence your approach to a scam-baiting session? (*e.g., revenge, fun, research, community protection, etc.*) ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

3. How do you typically gather the necessary information (phone numbers) about scammers before engaging with them? ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

- a) What resources or methods do you use to gather contact information? ($t=1\text{ m}$)

Answer:

- b) **How do you verify that the contact information (phone numbers) is associated with scammers?**

(t=1 m)

Answer:

- c) **Do you gather information manually or use any automated processes to streamline this step?**

(t=1 m)

Answer:

4. **What communication channels do you primarily use to contact scammers?** *(e.g., via phone, email, social media, SMS, etc.) (t=1 m)*

Answer:

5. **What precautions do you take to avoid detection by scammers?** *(How do you avoid being detected as a scam-baiter?) (t=2 m)*

Answer:

6. **How do you consider legal and ethical implications in your scam-baiting activities, and what steps do you take to ensure compliance with legal regulations in your jurisdiction?** *(t=2 m)*

Answer:

3 Tools and Technologies *(t=10 m)* (Answer: **t=xx m**) (xx:xx:xx - xx:xx:xx)

In this section, we explore the various tools and technologies that scam-baiters utilize to facilitate their activities. Understanding the technical setups and software employed can show how scam-baiters protect themselves and enhance their effectiveness during engagements.

1. **What hardware and software are essential to your scam-baiting process?** *(To know how your scam-baiting setup looks like.) (t=3 m)*

Answer:

2. **How do you manage the risk of scammers attempting to access your real personal information or systems?** *(How do you avoid being attacked, or harmed in anyway, by a scammer?) (t=2 m)*

Answer:

3. **What tools and technologies do you use to configure your system to appear like a genuine victim's system during an engagement?** *(t=2 m)*

Answer:

4. **What are the costs associated with your scam-baiting activities?** *(e.g., financial costs, time investment, resource allocation, etc.) (t=2 m)*

Answer:

5. **Do costs impact how you conduct scam-baiting or the frequency of your engagements?** *(t=1 m)*

Answer:

4 Engagement Process *(t=14 m)* (Answer: **t=xx m**) (xx:xx:xx - xx:xx:xx)

This section focuses on the methods and tactics scam-baiters employ during their interactions with scammers. By examining their engagement processes, we aim to understand how they initiate and sustain conversations and the techniques they use to influence the scammer's behavior.

1. **In your experience, when do you think is the best time of the day to initiate a scam-baiting session?** **And what days of the week are the best for scam-baiting?** *(t=3 m)*

Answer:

2. **Can you describe your strategy when engaging with a scammer?** *e.g., walk me through your typical process when engaging with a scammer over the phone. (t=2 m)*

Answer:

3. How do you typically start a conversation with a scammer? What tactics do you use to keep them engaged? (*starting with e.g., using certain keywords, tone, speech speed, speech volume, emotional state, etc.*) (*tactics like e.g., pretending to be confused or elderly*) ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

4. How do you respond when scammers ask for specific types of payment or information? ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

5. When does a call usually end with a scammer, and how do you handle moments when they become suspicious? ($t=3\text{ m}$)

Answer:

6. How do you gather information, or intelligence, about scammers during your engagements? (*e.g., techniques, tools, or resources to gain more information about a scammer.*) ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

5 Challenges and Responses ($t=10\text{ m}$) (Answer: $t=xx\text{ m}$) ($xx:xx:xx - xx:xx:xx$)

This section addresses the challenges scam-baiters encounter when dealing with scammers and how they respond to them. By identifying common obstacles and the strategies used to overcome them, we can gain insights into the resilience and adaptability required in scam-baiting.

1. What are the main challenges or pain points you face with scambaiting, and how do you overcome them? ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

2. Do your calls ever fail? If so, why and how do they fail? ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

3. Have you seen scammers changing their tactics over time? How do you adapt to these changes? ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

4. In cases where scammers become aggressive or threatening, how do you de-escalate the situation? ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

5. What tools or resources do you think could benefit the scam-baiting process? ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

6 Analysis and Outcomes ($t=11\text{ m}$) (Answer: $t=xx\text{ m}$) ($xx:xx:xx - xx:xx:xx$)

Here, we delve into how scam-baiters analyze their interactions post-engagement and the outcomes of their activities. We aim to understand how they reflect on their experiences, measure success, and the insights they gain about scammer operations.

1. How many calls do you make in a typical week (or month)? Does this number vary, and if so, what factors influence these variations? (*e.g., special holidays might affect scammers' interactions.*) ($t=1\text{ m}$)

Answer:

2. How do you define a successful call? (*e.g., wasting time*) ($t=2\text{ m}$)

Answer:

3. How long does a typical successful call last? Does this vary depending on the scammer's behavior? ($t=1\text{ m}$)

Answer:

4. How frequently are you successful according to your definition of a successful scam-baiting session?
($t=1$ m)

Answer:

5. How do you collect and analyze data from your engagements to identify patterns or improve your strategies? ($t=2$ m)

Answer:

6. What factors or outcomes would indicate that a scam-baiting system is effective in combating scams?
(What makes an effective scam-baiting system?) (factors like a scammer's behavior, the success rate, etc.) (outcomes like preventing a scammer from achieving their goal.) ($t=2$ m)

Answer:

7. After a scam-baiting session, how do you report the scammers, and to which authorities? (What do you do with your logs?) ($t=2$ m)

Answer:

7 Best Practices and Recommendations ($t=9$ m) (Answer: $t=xx$ m) (xx:xx:xx - xx:xx:xx)

This section gathers the best practices and recommendations from experienced scam-baiters. By learning about essential skills, knowledge, and advice for newcomers, we can compile guidance for those interested in engaging in scam-baiting safely and effectively.

1. Based on your experience, what best practices would you recommend to others interested in scam-baiting? ($t=2$ m)

Answer:

2. What skills or knowledge are essential for effective scam-baiting? ($t=2$ m)

Answer:

3. Do you have any advice for researchers or developers working on automated scam-baiting systems?
($t=2$ m)

Answer:

4. Have you used or are you aware of any automated tools or AI technologies in scam-baiting? ($t=2$ m)

Answer:

5. How receptive are you to integrating AI tools into your scam-baiting activities? ($t=1$ m)

Answer:

8 Conclusion ($t=5$ m) (Answer: $t=xx$ m) (xx:xx:xx - xx:xx:xx)

In the concluding section, we invite scam-baiters to share any additional thoughts or perspectives not covered in the previous sections. We also aim to understand their views on the overall impact of scam-baiting on combating TSS.

1. How do you think scam-baiting impacts the larger fight against technical support scams? ($t=2$ m)

Answer:

2. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experiences as a scam-baiter that we have not covered? ($t=2$ m)

Answer:

3. What country are you located in for gift card compensation? (US participants receive Tango Reward Link with 236 vendor options; Non-US participants receive region-specific Amazon gift cards) ($t=1$ m)

Answer:

Thank you for your valuable participation.